

TEDx Talk Summary

The Last Tool We Need to Retool Is *Ourselves*

Technology has always changed the tools we use. But the age of artificial intelligence is asking us to change something much more fundamental: ourselves.

Drawing on decades of experience in industrial robotics, AI, Industry 4.0, and immersive technologies, Dr. Khalid Mirza explores how each technological revolution has transformed the way we work, learn, and create. From industrial robots to artificial intelligence, tools are evolving faster than ever, and our traditional approaches to education and engineering must keep pace.

What will it take to prepare ourselves and the next generation for a future in which many of today's jobs, skills, and assumptions will change?

This talk challenges us to rethink what we teach, how we learn, and how we respond to technological change. The most important skills of the future may not be technical knowledge alone, but curiosity, adaptability, and the willingness to continually retool ourselves.

The tools are changing. Are we ready to change with them?

Biography



Dr. Khalid Mirza, Ph.D.

Dr. Khalid Mirza is a Special Instructor in Electrical and Computer Engineering at Oakland University with more than 30 years of experience in robotics, automation, and immersive technologies. He is the Director of the OU-Stellantis Control and Robotics Laboratory and the Founding Director of Oakland University's Augmented Reality Center (ARC), where he leads efforts to advance immersive technology education, research, and industry collaboration.

Dr. Mirza pioneered Oakland University's Industrial Robotics program and has built strong partnerships between academia and industry to provide students with hands-on experience in robotics and emerging technologies. His research and teaching span industrial robotics, machine vision, AI, autonomous systems, and augmented and virtual reality, with a focus on applying these technologies to transform how people work, learn, and interact with technology.

He holds a Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering from The Ohio State University and is passionate about preparing the next generation of engineers to adapt, innovate, and thrive in a rapidly changing technological world.